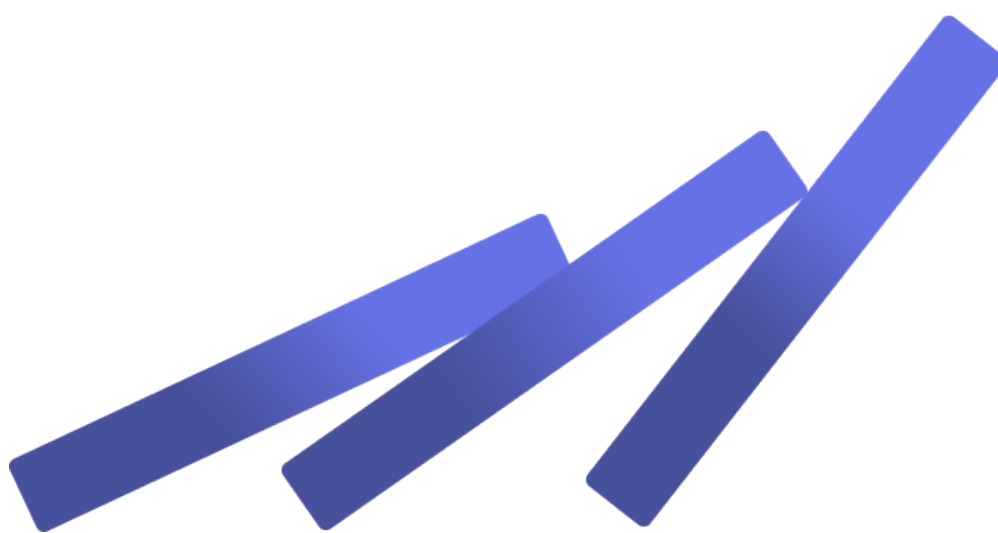


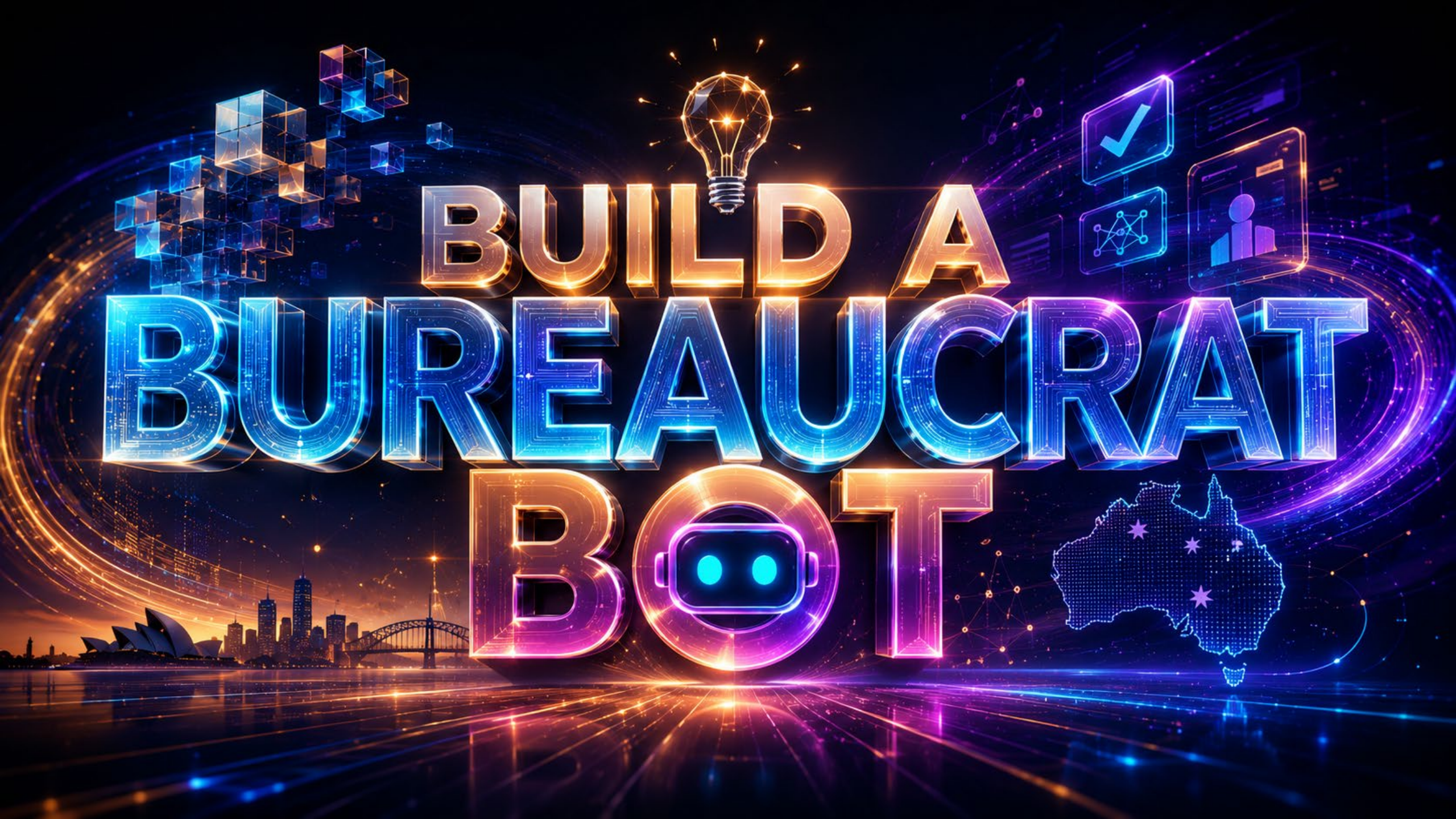
INNOVATION MONTH 2026



READY  
OR NOT...



# BUILD A BUREAUCRAT BOT





# The Build a Bureaucrat Bot challenge

The capabilities of AI are changing every day – how might we use these powerful new capabilities to help us and the people we serve?

The Build a Bureaucrat Bot challenge is a chance to learn through serious play and discovery and helping to educate and inspire others

To enter you need to make sure you're signed up as a member of the Digital Profession

The five winning entries will receive a \$100 JB HiFi gift card (with thanks to the DTA!)





# Judging panel

Winners will be chosen from shortlisted entries by our Chief AI Officer judging panel:

- Amanda Chalmers  
Chief Digital and Data Officer, First Assistant Secretary  
Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry
- Simon Cooper  
A/g Chief Data and AI Officer, First Assistant Secretary  
Department of Home Affairs
- Andrew Morrison  
Chief Technology Officer  
Digital Transformation Agency
- Alicja Mosbauer  
Chief Data Officer/ Assistant Secretary  
Department of Veterans' Affairs
- Samantha Yorke  
Authority Member and Chief AI Officer  
Australian Communications and Media Authority





# Award categories

## 1. The Chief AI Officer's Aide

For the bot that best helps senior leaders turn AI ambition into responsible agency action.

This category is for tools that support strategic decision-making, adoption planning, governance, maturity assessment, prioritisation, risk framing or executive briefings.

## 2. The Workday Wingmate

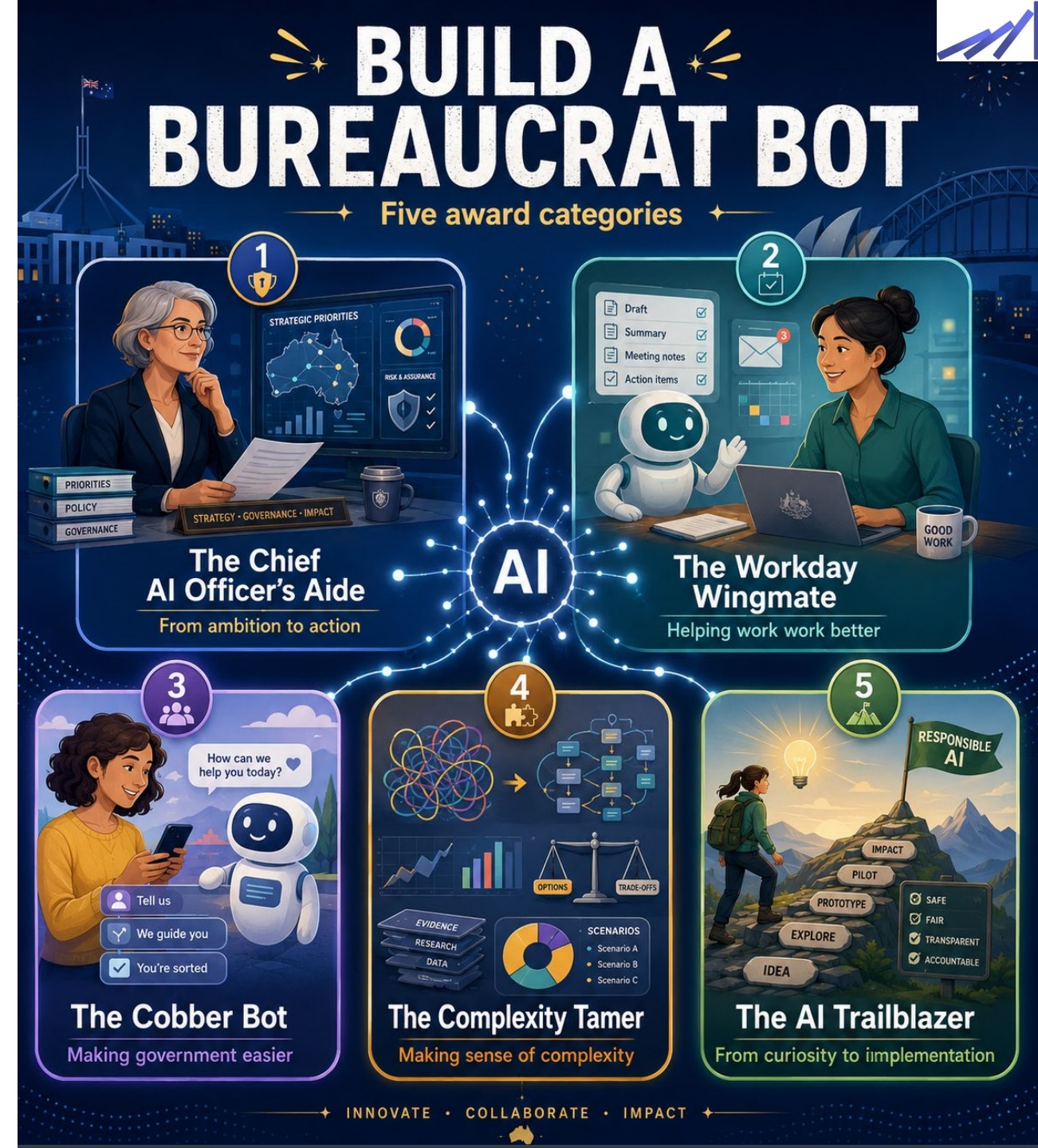
For the bot that best helps public servants get their work done better.

This is the practical productivity category: drafting, planning, summarising, navigating internal guidance, preparing meetings, improving correspondence, supporting teams, or making routine work less painful.

## 3. The Cobber Bot

For the bot that best helps everyday Australians deal with government.

This is for citizen-facing or public-facing ideas that make services, obligations, forms, decisions, entitlements or processes easier to understand and engage with.





# Award categories

## 4. The Complexity Tamer

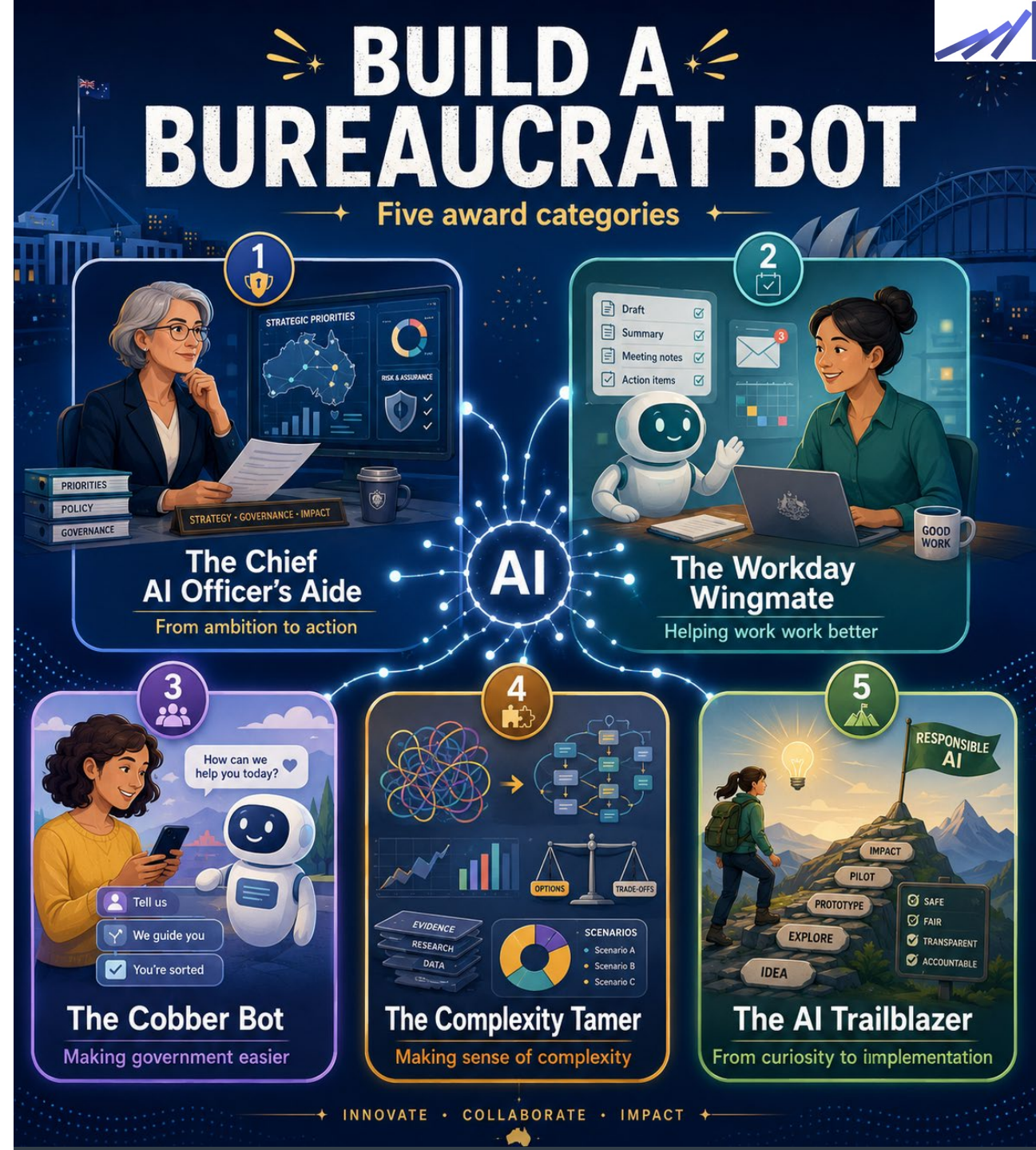
For the bot that best helps people understand messy, complex or uncertain issues.

This category rewards tools for policy, research, modelling, simulation, evidence synthesis, system mapping, scenario testing or making trade-offs more visible.

## 5. The AI Trailblazer

For the bot that best helps public servants experiment with and implement AI.

This is for tools that help teams move from curiosity to responsible practice: identifying opportunities, designing experiments, working through risks, building confidence, planning implementation, or scaling what works.





# The parameters

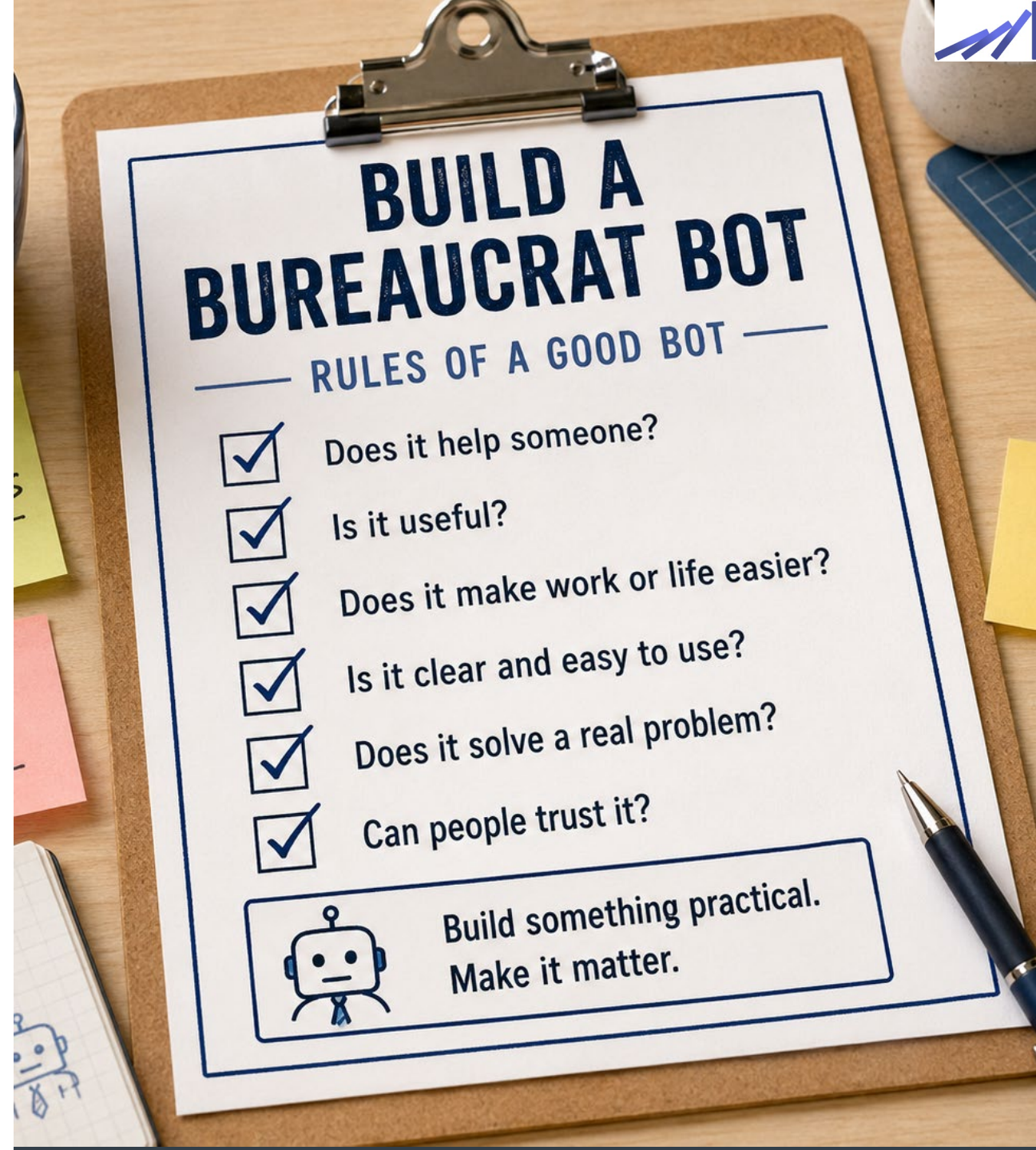
- The bot must be interactive and use generative AI capability.
- No coding experience is required — no-code, low-code and prompt-based builds are welcome.
- Entries must only use public, synthetic, fictional or otherwise authorised information – so don't use classified, sensitive, or personal information.
- Entries must not use tools, models or platforms prohibited by current PSPF Directions, namely DeepSeek.





# The rules of the game

- Entries must align with the APS Code of Conduct and be in the spirit of Australia's AI Ethics Principles, and respect copyright, licences and platform terms.
- The Bureaucrat Bot needs to be clearly identified as part of its visible description as being part of Innovation Month 2026 (please use **IM2026** in the name somewhere).
- Entries must not impersonate government, provide official decisions, or present themselves as authoritative government services.
- Entries must be accessible to judges (i.e. accessible by a link that you share).
- Each entrant may only be part of one submitted entry, either individually or as part of a team.





# How to enter

- Send your entry by **9am Monday 20 July** to [InnovationMonth@finance.gov.au](mailto:InnovationMonth@finance.gov.au) with the subject heading 'Build a Bureaucrat Bot entry', either sent from or cc'ing your work (.gov.au) email address
- Entries need to include:
  - Your name, position and agency
  - A catchy name for the bot
  - What the intent of the bureaucrat bot is and how it fits with the spirit of the challenge, including which category(ies) you think it fits
  - Entries need to include a short "bot card" explaining purpose, intended users, information used, limitations, risks and tools used
  - Your acknowledgement that the bot is your work
- At the end we hope to publish a list of/ link to entries including your name and agency – if you're on LinkedIn and don't want us to tag you, let us know





# Your entry checklist

| Have I ensured...                                                                                                                     | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| I'm a member of the <a href="#">Digital Profession</a> ?                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My bot is interactive and has gen AI capability?                                                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My bot is not out of whack with the <a href="#">APS Code of Conduct</a> and <a href="#">AI Ethics Principles</a> ?                    | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| The name / description of the bot clearly includes IM2026?                                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My bot is visible to others (either publicly or via a shared link)?                                                                   | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| I'm happy with this as my one entry?                                                                                                  | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My email with the bot link includes my name, position and agency?                                                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My email with the bot link is coming from, or cc's, my .gov.au work address?                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My email includes a brief description of the bot, its intent and how it fits with the spirit of the Build a Bureaucrat Bot challenge? | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My email includes a 'bot card' with information to help the judges understand how it was created/what's involved?                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| My email includes my acknowledgement that the bot is my own work?                                                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| The email with my entry is being sent to <a href="mailto:InnovationMonth@Finance.gov.au">InnovationMonth@Finance.gov.au</a> ?         | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| I have submitted my entry by 9am Monday 20 July?                                                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/>            |

